

Google I/O 2015, Android Pay also used Google-acquired Softcard's payment tech. While Android Pay works with pretty much all of Google's ecosystem, Wallet is still functional on Google Play Store as well as peer to peer payments on Gmail. Since its launch, Android Pay's major progress has been in terms of adding supporting banks and services. While PayPal integration has been available for a while now, Visa checkout has reportedly been added recently.

While Android Pay mainly works on NFC and host-based card emulation (HCE), it also puts to use Android security features and additional security measures like fingerprints where available and opted for. With a growing impetus towards facial recognition as a security measure, we do expect 'pay with your face' to become an Android Pay feature in the future as well.

Android Pay also supports loyalty cards from stores. Using loyalty cards works the same way as normal credit or debit cards - you hold the NFC enabled phone near the terminal when it asks for the card and the details are transmitted. Of Course, you also need to complete the actual transaction with a payment card.

The HCE system makes payments fairly secure by never sharing your actual card details. Instead, a virtual token is passed that is used to authenticate your card's details.

There are some significant differences between Android Pay and its competing services in the market. For instance, payment via smartphone on Apple Pay mandates the use of fingerprint authentication, which is not the case in Android Pay - a decision taken probably with the diverse range of Android phones in mind. Samsung Pay, although restricted to Samsung phones, is compatible with a larger number of terminals as compared to both Android Pay (as well as Apple Pay). That is because it uses Magnetic Secure Transmission (MST) technology that allows it to emit a magnetic signal that acts like magnetic strip that you find on most credit or debit cards.



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